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MUSIC AT STANFORD

VOLUPTUOUS VIRTUOSITY: BUSNOYS AND OCKEGHEM, CA. 1465

Cut Circle and the students of "Performance as Analysis: Late-Medieval Music in Action" (Music 159J)

Jesse Rodin,
DIRECTOR

MEMORIAL CHURCH
WEDNESDAY,
13 JANUARY, 2016
7:30 P.M.

STANFORD UNIVERSITY DEPARTMENT OF MUSIC

PROGRAM

Je m'esbaïs de vous mon cuer — **Antoine de Busnes, dit "Busnoys"** (ca. 1432–1490)

Michela Macfarlane, *discantus*
Steven Soph, *contratenor*
Bradford Gleim, *tenor*

Missa Ecce ancilla domini — **Johannes Ockeghem** (d. 1497)
Kyrie
Gloria

Students of Music 159J

In hydraulis — **Busnoys**

Students of Music 159J

Maintes femmes — **Busnoys**

Carolann Buff, *discantus*
Steven Soph, *contratenor altus*
Bradford Gleim, *tenor*
Paul Max Tipton, *contratenor bassus*

A vous sans aultre — **Busnoys**

Michela Macfarlane, *discantus*
Carolann Buff, *discantus*
Herbert Myers, *vielle*

Missa Ecce ancilla domini — **Ockeghem**
Credo

Students of Music 159J

Quant vous me ferez — **Busnoys**

Carolann Buff, *discantus*
Bradford Gleim, *tenor*
Paul Max Tipton, *contratenor bassus*

A qui vens tu tes coquilles — **Busnoys**

Michela Macfarlane, *discantus*
Carolann Buff, *discantus*
Paul Max Tipton, *contratenor bassus*

Missa Ecce ancilla domini — **Ockeghem**
Sanctus

Students of Music 159J

ABOUT THE DIRECTOR

Jesse Rodin is Associate Professor of Music at Stanford University and co-editor of the *Journal of Musicology*. He is the author of *Josquin's Rome: Hearing and Composing in the Sistine Chapel* (Oxford University Press, 2012), editor of a volume of *L'homme armé masses* for the *New Josquin Edition* (2014), and co-editor of *The Cambridge History of Fifteenth-Century Music* (2015). He directs the Josquin Research Project (josquin.stanford.edu), a digital tool for exploring a large corpus of Renaissance music. Current projects include a monograph on "form" in 15th-century music, with Cambridge University Press, and a collaborative medieval feasting-plus-music event with Cut Circle and San Francisco-based chef Jason Fox.

Rodin is the recipient of awards and fellowships from the Université Libre de Bruxelles, the American Musicological Society, the American Council of Learned Societies, and the American Society of Composers, Authors, and Publishers. As a performer he has conducted masterclasses, given pre-concert lectures, and prepared editions for Cut Circle and other ensembles. He leads the Facsimile Singers, a group at Stanford that sings from copies of Renaissance music manuscripts and prints. He also teaches the freshman seminar "Singing Early Music," in which students study, rehearse, and perform a collection of pieces from before 1600.

CUT CIRCLE

Carolann Buff and Michela Macfarlane, *discantus*

Steven Soph, *contratenor altus*

Bradford Gleim, *tenor*

Paul Max Tipton, *contratenor bassus*

STUDENTS OF MUSIC 159J

Frances Molyneux, Kyle Michelle Robinson, Danielle Smith, and Shu Chen Ong, *discantus*

Mackenzie Lee, Christopher Ryan Swenson, and Eric Tuan, *contratenor altus*

Daniel Borup, Jeremy Raven, and Will Watson, *tenor*

Joel Chapman, Charles Jacob Foster, and Daniel Jonathan Wesche, *contratenor bassus*

Terrible dame **Busnoys**

Michela Macfarlane, *discantus*
Carolann Buff, *tenor*
Steven Soph, *tenor*
Bradford Gleim, *bassus*
Herbert Myers, *vielle*

Missa Ecce ancilla domini **Ockeghem**
Agnus Dei

All

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

This project has been supported by the Hume Program Endowment Fund for the Arts in Stanford Arts.

The large-format editions from which we are performing were prepared by Craig Sapp and Jesse Rodin using Walter Hewlett's MuseData printing system.

The exquisite music lectern from which we are singing is modeled after a 15th-century original housed in the Bargello in Florence. It was created in 2013 by a team of master woodworkers in Mendocino, CA led by Richard Anderson (rwaridge@mcn.org). The commission was made possible by funds from the Stanford Arts Institute and the Department of Music.

Thanks to the Stanford Department of Music, and to Mario Champagne, Daphna Davidson, William Keats, Scott Kepley, Beatrice Kitzinger, Sara Langlands, Joan Mansour, Herbert Myers, Alejandro Enrique Planchart, Stephen M. Sano, Craig Sapp, Audrey Shafer, Eric Tuan, and Velda Williams.

Adrian Armstrong (Queen Mary University of London) provided English translations of the songs on tonight's program, as well as advice on the texts and pronunciation.

To Ensure a More Pleasant Experience for All: *No food, drink, or smoking is permitted in the building. Cameras and other recording equipment are prohibited. Please ensure that your phone, other electronic devices, or watch alarm are all turned off.*
An Additional Note to Parents: *We appreciate your effort in bringing your children to a live music performance. Out of respect for other audience members and the performers, we count on you to maintain their quiet and attentive behavior. Thank you.*

PROGRAM NOTES

About this Concert

The elite ensemble of Stanford students and recent alumni performing tonight convened for the first time nine days ago. Since then we've worked tirelessly, meeting almost daily to prepare a program of works famous for their complexity. Our rehearsals have been markedly non-traditional. For one thing, we've had to get used to standing bunched together while reading from a single, large "book," just as 15th-century singers did. For another, we've regularly interrupted our rehearsals to reflect on the experience of performing this music, asking questions ranging from "How did the composer conceive the passage we just sang?" to "Why did they hold onto (or tap the beat on) each other's shoulders — and what might this practice tell us about the role of the human body in late-medieval religious devotion?"

Indeed our meetings have been more like workshops than rehearsals, in part thanks to an array of high-profile visitors. As part of the course to which this concert is tethered (Music 159J: "Performance as Analysis: Late-Medieval Music in Action"), we've thought about visual culture and sensory experience with the help of Professor Beatrice Kitzinger, an art historian at Princeton University; about the inner-workings of Antoine Busnoys's *In hydraulis* with Will Watson, a Stanford alumnus ('14) who is now a Musicology Ph.D. student at Yale University; and about using digital visualization tools to enhance our understanding of the music with Professor Craig Sapp, a computer scientist at Stanford's Center for Computer Assisted Research in the Humanities (CCARH) and Technical Director of the Josquin Research Project (josquin.stanford.edu).

Meanwhile we've benefited hugely from the presence of Cut Circle (cutcircle.org). The professional singers have offered advice about phrasing 15th-century lines, navigating vocal challenges, and working together as an ensemble. They've also divided the students into smaller groups to address issues specific to a given voice part (e.g., How should the tenors approach lines characterized by strings of extremely long notes?). Even if the professionals will join the students only at the end of the concert, for the *Agnus Dei* of Johannes Ockeghem's *Missa Ecce ancilla domini*, their contributions can be felt throughout the program.

In between sections of Ockeghem's mass, Cut Circle, joined now and then on vielle by Stanford's own Professor Herbert Myers, will perform a collection of 15th-century love songs from the courts of France and Burgundy. These songs are scandalously underperformed — and so it is worth reporting that starting tomorrow, Cut Circle will use the studio at Stanford's CCRMA (Center for Computer Research in Musical Acoustics) to record an album of *chansons* by Busnoys and Ockeghem. (Part of the goal of this recording is to explore the different acoustical environments in which these songs were undoubtedly performed.) Before you leave, consider purchasing a copy of Cut Circle's 2012 album *De Orto*

of Christus in Bach's *St. John Passion* with the Back Bay Chorale in Boston; the role of Apollon in Rameau's La Lyre Enchantée with Jacques Ogg and the Lyra Baroque Orchestra in Saint Paul; and a recording of the Brahms Requiem with Seraphic Fire andset to set the wordsall in 2007, and soloed under Leonard Slatkin on the Naxos recording of William Bolcom's Songs of Innocence and of Experience, a project that won three Grammys in 2006. He has sung Schaunard in La Bohème with the New York Opera Society while on tour in Toulouse, and has worked closely with composer Ricky Ian Gordon, joining him twice in recital in Ann Arbor and Florence, Italy.

Mr. Tipton is based in Boston, and is a 2010 graduate of the Yale University Institute of Sacred Music, where he studied with tenor James Taylor.

Herbert Myers is Lecturer in Recorder / Early Wind Instruments and Curator of the Harry R. Lange Historical Collection of Musical Instruments and Bows at Stanford University, from which he holds a D.M.A. in Performance Practices of Early Music. As a member of the Concert Ensemble of the New York Pro Musica from 1970 to 1973, he toured extensively throughout North and South America, performing on a variety of early winds and strings; currently, he performs with Bay Area ensembles The Whole Noyse and Jubilate.

A recognized expert in the history of musical instruments, he has contributed articles and reviews to a number of specialist journals and guides to historical performance. His designs for reproductions of Renaissance winds have been used by Günter Körber (Berlin) and Charles Collier (Berkeley).

ABOUT THE WORKSHOP / COURSE PARTICIPANTS

Daniel Borup: Stanford Ph.D. student in Mechanical Engineering.

Joel Chapman: Stanford '14, now conductor, singer, and songwriter.

Charles Jacob Foster: Stanford '18

Mackenzie Lee: Stanford '10 (Public Policy), '11 (Management Science & Engineering)

Frances Molyneux: Stanford Ph.D. student in English

Shu Chen Ong: Stanford '17.

Jeremy Raven: Stanford '18.

Kyle Michelle Robinson: Stanford '18.

Danielle Smith: Stanford '16.

Christopher Ryan Swenson: Stanford '18.

Eric Tuan: Stanford '12, now the Stanford Choral Studies Program Administrator and director of the ensemble Convivium.

Daniel Jonathan Wesche: Stanford Ph.D. student in Stem Cell Biology and Regenerative Medicine.

Will Watson: Stanford '14; now a Ph.D. student in Musicology at Yale University.

Soprano **Michela Macfarlane** maintains an active and colorful musical lifestyle. Starting in 1998 Michela enjoyed a decade of appearing with leading Renaissance and Baroque ensembles, including Tragicomedia, Concerto Palatino, the Boston Early Music Festival Chorus, Boston Bach Ensemble, Blue Heron, and the Sweelinck Ensemble. She has sung on stages as far and wide as England, Israel, and Romania, and spent two separate years in Venice, Italy. More recently Michela has crossed over to the eclectic worlds of jazz, latin, acoustic folk, and pop, singing and playing ukulele in and around Murphys, CA, with her band Cantamos, and singing across many genres with San Francisco's Musæ. Michela is thrilled to be making her debut with Cut Circle. She attributes her vocal flexibility to her experience with the methods of Feldenkrais and Estill Voice Training, not to mention raising her two spirited little boys. She holds a B.A. in Voice from UCSD and a M.M. in Early Vocal Performance from Longy School of Music, both with honors.

A "superb vocal soloist" (*Washington Post*) possessing a "sweetly soaring tenor" (*Dallas Morning News*) of "impressive clarity and color" (*New York Times*), tenor **Steven Soph** performs throughout the U.S. and Europe. He appeared recently with the Cleveland Orchestra under Ton Koopman in an all-Handel program at Severance Hall, with Symphony Orchestra Augusta for Bach's *B-minor Mass*, as Jephte in Carissimmi's *Jephte* with the Baroque Chamber Orchestra of Colorado, with Musica Sacra in Beethoven's *Choral Fantasy* at Lincoln Center's Alice Tully Hall, as Uriel in Haydn's Creation with Texas Choral Consort (named a 2014 "Top 10" performance by the *Austin Chronicle*), and at Musica Sacra Festival Maastricht, The Netherlands, performing works of Brumel and Josquin with Cut Circle.

Soph appears with many top American ensembles including twice-Grammy-nominated Seraphic Fire; Grammy Award-winning Conspirare; Grammy Award-winning Roomful of Teeth; Trident; Yale Choral Artists; Cut Circle; Santa Fe Desert Chorale; True Concord Voices & Orchestra; Colorado Bach Ensemble; Apollo Master Chorale of Minneapolis; American Classical Orchestra Chorus; Spire Chamber Ensemble; GRAMMY-nominated Choir of Trinity Wall Street, NYC; Choir of the Church of the Advent, Boston; and the Choir of St. John's Cathedral, Denver.

Soph holds degrees from the University of North Texas and Yale School of Music where he studied with renowned tenor James Taylor at Yale's Institute of Sacred Music.

Described by the *Atlanta Journal–Constitution* as a dignified and beautiful singer, **Paul Max Tipton**, baritone, is building an impressive career in opera, oratorio, and early music. Upcoming and recent engagements include Britten's *War Requiem* with the Lincoln Symphony Orchestra and the American Boy Choir; concerts of Charpentier and Couperin with Ensemble VIII in Austin; the part

and Josquin, and signing up for our mailing list to learn more about another upcoming release: *Guillaume Du Fay : Les Messes à Teneur (The Tenor Masses)* (Musique en Wallonie, to be published in March).

The Program

In the late middle ages and Renaissance, the boundary between the sacred and the secular was extremely thin. So-called "secular" texts could take on religious meanings if interpreted in the right way, and sacred themes could have relevance in, or even be debased by, all manner of secular contexts. In music we can observe this swirl of the religious and the non-religious in myriad ways, perhaps above all through the common practice of basing settings of the Mass Ordinary on courtly love songs.

This much is well known. Still, it is rare for a concert of 15th-century music to combine a mass, the most formal polyphonic musical genre of its day, with songs about unattainable women. Something about this combination strikes us as unseemly — perhaps because for us moderns, the secular and the sacred are distinct realms that, if fully integrated, risk offending one another.

Tonight we take this risk, asserting that late-medieval listeners would have not only tolerated but probably also enjoyed thinking about how musical settings of French and Latin texts inform one another. The centerpiece of the program is a mass by Ockeghem based on a chant for the Annunciation of the Virgin (*Ecce ancilla domini*). In between sections of the mass we intersperse songs about women who can be thought of as stand-ins for the Virgin Mary, more or less. There is certainly no contradiction in applying a sacred interpretation to a text describing a face that is "beautiful, pleasing, and tender" (*A vous sans aultre*). But a Marian reading is also possible with respect to a woman who has "put a stop to loving us" (*Je m'esbaïs de vous*); to one who is "frightful," causing at least a metaphorical death because she withholds her affection (*Terrible dame*); or even to a lady to whom the speaker offers a deal: "When you do me more good / Than you're doing for me right now, / Then you'll be so sure of me / That nobody could say how much" (*Quant vous me ferez*). Fifteenth-century listeners could well have read Mary into these songs, just as they could have been spurred to reflect on their own, worldly objects of desire when encountering idealized depictions of the Virgin during High Mass.

All these songs are rich with emotion. Indeed we believe that the best music from this period is intense, even passionate, and demands intense, passionate singing. Even when performing a setting of the Mass, we embrace the music's undeniable energy and vitality. These ideas are reflected in our theme: "Voluptuous Virtuosity" aims to capture the extraordinary sophistication and expressivity one finds in the music of Johannes Ockeghem and Antoine Busnoys. The works assembled here are at once visceral and complex, immediate and rarified, heady and sensual.

Je m'esbaïs de vous mon cuer
Busnoys's *rondeau* showcases 15th-century courtly love poetry at its most refined. The supple melody, in the top voice, moves gracefully through the poem, arriving at a cadence at the end of each line of text without ever losing momentum. In several passages Busnoys coordinates the voices in striking ways, as at "maincte**nez**" ("maintain") and its repetitions, where the upper voices ascend together to their highest notes.

All the *rondeaux* on tonight's program adhere to the fixed form AB aA ab AB, where A and B represent distinct musical sections, and capital letters indicate textual repetition. The *rondeau* is characterized by two important and interlocking dynamics: first, that after the opening refrain (AB) one must wait a long time (aA a) before hearing the B music again; and second, that when the refrain is repeated at the end (AB), it often takes on new meaning.

(*Rondeau*, in the form AB aA ab AB)

A	Je m'esbaïs de vous, mon cuer, Dont tant mainctenez la foleur De plus servir nostre maistresse.	You astound me, my heart, By persisting so much in the folly Of still serving our mistress,
B	Veu que savez qu'elle a fait cesse De nous aimer, c'est grant [erreur].	Since you know she's put a stop To loving us — it's a great error.
a	Vray est que tant a de valeur Que c'estoit pour nous grant honneur. Mais toutesfois, quis qu'elle lesse,	It's true that she has such worth That it was a great honor for us. Nevertheless, since she's dropping us,
A	Je m'esbais de vous…	You astound me…
a	Deportez vous, c'est le milleur, Sans plus acroistre ma douleur;	Leave — it's the best thing to do — Without further increasing my pain;
b	Par dieu j'en ay assez, Largesse, Votre bonté et gentillesse Me facent paie[r] pour ma faveur.	By God, I've had enough, Largesse; Your goodness and kindness Make me pay for the favor I've enjoyed.
AB	Je m'esbais de vous…	You astound me…

Missa Ecce ancilla domini (a 4): Kyrie and *Gloria*
Ockeghem's *Missa Ecce ancilla domini* was thought special enough to be accorded pride of place in a lavish choirbook: the celebrated *Chigi Codex*, copied ca. 1504 at the Hapsburg-Burgundian court. In this manuscript the first Kyrie is handsomely decorated, with coats of arms, a donor portrait, and a miniature of the Annunciation of the Virgin that echoes the Marian chant *Ecce ancilla domini* ("Behold the handmaiden of God") upon which the mass is based.

There is enough to listen for in this mass to justify ten consecutive performances. (Don't worry.) At the beginning of the *Kyrie* you might start with Ockeghem's use of texture: a long upper-voice duet gives way to a trio involving the tenor; only

with that ensemble she recorded two critically acclaimed CDs of 14th-century polyphony: *Unrequited: Machaut and the French Ars Nova* and *Flyleaves: Music in English Manuscripts.*

Buff's principal research interests include 14th- and early 15th-century musical style, but she is equally at home in the study of sacred repertoires from all eras, as well as contemporary popular music. Her dissertation, "Ciconia's Equal-Cantus Motets and the Creation of Early-15th Century Style," and her essay, "The Italian Job: Ciconia, Du Fay, and the Musical Aesthetics of the 15th-Century Italian Motet" (the latter published in *Qui musicam in se habet: Essays in Honor of Alejandro Enrique Planchart*), explore the motet genre in the period between the end of the Middle Ages and the beginning of the Renaissance. She has presented papers at the annual meeting of the American Musicological Society, the International Congress on Medieval Studies, the Medieval and Renaissance Music Conference, and an international symposium on Philippe de Vitry at Yale University.

In 2015 Buff joined the faculty of Westminster Choir College of Rider University as an Assistant Professor of Musicology in the Department of Conducting, Organ, and Sacred Music. She holds a Ph.D. and M.A. in Musicology from Princeton University, an M.M. in Early Music Performance from Longy School of Music, and a B.M. in Vocal Performance from the University of California at Santa Barbara.

Boston-based baritone **Bradford Gleim** performs opera, oratorio, and chamber music to critical acclaim. Gleim's "rich, expressive voice" had been described as "consistently impressive, his restraint only reinforced by his vocal charisma"; his flexible burnished baritone has been praised as "reliable and resonant." He has appeared with such groups as Boston Cecilia, The Mark Morris Dance Group, Opera Boston, and The New Haven Symphony.

In the 2014–15 season, Mr. Gleim was featured in Monteverdi's *Vespers of 1610* with Boston Baroque, Bach's *St. John Passion* with Emmanuel Music, *Carmina Burana* with the Andover Choral Society, Bach's *B Minor Mass* with Musica Sacra, and the Brahms *Requiem* at Berklee Performance Center. In past seasons Mr. Gleim has been heard as a soloist with Boston's premiere period orchestras: the Handel and Haydn Society under Harry Christophers and Boston Baroque with Martin Pearlman. He has offered recitals at the Longy School of Music, the Taylor House, and Boston College. Mr. Gleim was proud to be honored with the Borromeo String Quartet's Guest Artist Award in 2008 and to subsequently perform Samuel Barber's *Dover Beach* with the quartet in Jordan Hall.

An active recording artist, Mr. Gleim has recorded on the Coro, Harmonia Mundi, and Musique en Wallonie labels, as well as with Linn Records, and is frequently involved in recording projects at WBGH Studios. Bradford Gleim is a passionate teacher and serves as Assistant Professor of Voice at Berklee College of Music.

ABOUT THE ARTISTS

Cut Circle (cutcircle.org) recaptures the gritty, intense experience of singing early music. Like 15th-century singers depicted shoulder to shoulder, concentrating fiercely on their virtuosic lines, we commit to the music emotionally and physically, embracing confident singing, gripping dynamic contrasts, and energetic tempi.

Our performances are informed by deep knowledge of the music's twists and turns, as well as cutting-edge research that relies on primary documents to unlock questions of performance practice. As a non-profit organization we give concerts and lecture-recitals, organize workshops, and publish recordings for students, scholars, and general audiences alike. The ensemble has performed at venues throughout the United States and in Europe, with recent festival appearances at Musica Sacra (Maastricht, The Netherlands) and Laus Polyphoniæ (Antwerp, Belgium), and an upcoming performance at Tage Alter Musik (Regensburg, Germany).

Founded in 2003 by Jesse Rodin (Artistic Director), the ensemble has been praised for its "masterful," "driving," and "expressive" performances of music by Guillaume Du Fay, Johannes Ockeghem, Josquin des Prez, and their contemporaries. Cut Circle is the 2010 recipient of the Noah Greenberg Award (American Musicological Society), which recognizes outstanding contributions to historical performing practices. Our album *De Orto and Josquin: Music in the Sistine Chapel around 1490* is available from Musique en Wallonie. A new album, *Guillaume Du Fay : Les Messes à Teneur* (*The Tenor Masses*) is soon to appear with the same label. Tomorrow afternoon we will begin recording an album of *chansons* by Busnoys and Ockeghem at Stanford's CCRMA.

The ensemble is named for a symbol that in the 15th century functioned as both a time signature and a tempo marking — and indeed we take seriously the tempo implications of signs such as "Cut Circle."

Carolann Buff is a scholar, teacher, and musician, regarded for both her research on late-medieval motets and expertise in historical performance. She appears frequently with early music ensembles and as a soloist with period-instrument orchestras. She has recorded with the Renaissance choir Cut Circle, and can be heard on their much admired CD, *De Orto and Josquin: Music in the Sistine Chapel around 1490*; she also appears on their forthcoming recording *Guillaume Du Fay : Les Messes à Teneur* (*The Tenor Masses*). With the Boston Camerata, Buff has toured around the world in the ballet *Borrowed Light*, a stunning collaboration with the Tero Saarinen Dance Company. Buff has also performed with the women's ensemble Tapestry and can be heard on their CD *Sapphire Night,* which received the 2005 ECHO Klassik prize in Germany. She is a founding member of the internationally renowned medieval trio Liber unUsualis;

in the final moments does the bass enter, introducing notes far lower than we have heard up until this point and initiating a drive to the cadence. Intriguingly, roughly the same scheme — opening upper-voice duo, trio involving the tenor, then a conclusion in full texture — is used for each section of the *Kyrie*. But it is the very first duo of the Mass that really counts: this opening, or "head motive," will be repeated — and transformed — at the head of each subsequent movement.

In the *Gloria* the introductory duet is greatly expanded. Notice in particular what happens at "Laudamus te": as the top voice drops out the bass suddenly enters, joining the contratenor in a rhythmically charged duo that makes mince meat of the prevailing triple-meter pulse. In the *Qui tollis*, Ockeghem writes for various combinations of two and three voices, largely avoiding full texture until "Amen." The final moments of the movement feature the most compelling ascending sequence in the repertory, based on a pattern of rising fourths.

Kyrie

Kyrie eleyson.	Lord, have mercy.
Christe eleyson.	Christ, have mercy.
Kyrie eleyson.	Lord, have mercy.

Gloria

Gloria in excelsis Deo	Glory to God in the highest
Et in terra pax hominibus bone voluntatis.	And on earth peace to men of goodwill.
Laudamus te. Benedicimus te.	We praise you. We bless you.
Adoramus te. Glorificamus te.	We adore you. We glorify you.
Gratias agimus tibi propter magnam gloriam tuam.	We give you thanks for your great glory.
Domine deus, rex celestis, deus pater omnipotens,	Lord God, heavenly king, almighty God and father,
domine fili unigenite, Jesu Christe;	Lord Jesus Christ, only son of the father;
domine deus, agnus dei, filius patris:	Lord God, lamb of God, son of the father:
Qui tollis peccata mundi,	You who take away the sins of the world;
miserere nobis;	have mercy on us.
qui tollis peccata mundi,	You who take away the sins of the world;
suscipe deprecationem nostram;	receive our prayer;
qui sedes ad dexteram patris,	You sit at the right hand of the father;
miserere nobis.	have mercy on us.
Quoniam tu solus sanctus,	For you alone are holy,
tu solus dominus,	You alone are God,
tu solus altissimus Jesu Christe.	You alone are the most high, Jesus Christ.
Cum sancto spiritu in gloria dei patris.	With the holy spirit, in the glory of God the father.
Amen.	Amen.

In hydraulis (a 4)

The strange and wonderful text of *In hydraulis* treats the subject of music itself. In the *prima pars* Pythagoras is the star of the show, with mention of water organs ("hydraulis"), the monochord, and, most spectacularly in Busnoys's setting, hemiola ("hemioliam"). The *secunda pars* sets its sights on Ockeghem, in relation to whom Busnoys describes himself as an offspring (*propago*). This section begins with a gesture drawn from one of Ockeghem's own compositions, set to the words "Hæc Ockeghem" (This Ockeghem) in clear imitation. We are — just as Ockeghem was — meant to notice.

Meanwhile the tenor is subject to a rigid and practically minimalist repetition scheme. It sings nothing but the three-note pattern re-ut-re, climbing gradually up the scale (statements begin successively on d, a, and d′), then back down again (d′, a, and d), with each statement separated by intervening rests. Amidst the tenor's comings and goings Busnoys achieves extraordinary variety. Note in particular a shift to triple meter in the concluding section ("Tamquam summum").

In hydraulis quondam Pythagora
Admirante melos phtongitates
Malleorum percussa equora
Per ponderum inequalitates
Adinvenit muse quiditates.
Epitritum ac hemioliam,
Epogdoi et duplam perducunt
Nam tessaron pente concordiam
Nec non phtongum et pason adducunt
Monocordi dum genus conducunt.

Pythagoras, in former times, admiring the
melodies of water organs, and the sounds of
hammers on struck surfaces,
by the inequalities of their weights
discovered the natures of the Muses.
Epitrite and hemiola,
epogdoon and duple produce
the concord of fourth and fifth,
the tone and the octave,
while they draw together the species of
the monochord.

Hec Okeghem qui cunctis
precinis
Galliarum in regis aula,
Practiculum tue propaginis
Arma cernens quondam per atria
Burgundie ducis in patria.
Per me Busnoys illustris comitis
De Charolois indignum musicum,
Saluteris tuis pro meritis
Tamquam summum chephas tropidium;
Vale, verum instar Orpheicum!

You, Ockeghem, who sing these harmonies
before all
in the hall of the king of the French,
strengthen the practice of your progeny,
as you perceive it on occasion in the halls
of the Duke of Burgundy in your homeland.
Through me, Busnoys, unworthy musician
of the illustrious Count of Charolais,
may you be greeted according to your merits
as the supreme head of melody;
hail, true image of Orpheus!

Terrible dame

This audacious little song begins in *fauxbourdon* — that is, parallel sonorities in which the voices track one another other up and down the scale. Set as a dialogue between a lover and his unwilling lady, we hear a series of sharp contrasts during the opening exchange, then another, still more dramatic shift ("C'est par deffault"), as the speaker gives vent to his frustration. Busnoys doesn't hold back.

Terrible dame:
Que vous fault?
Je meurs.
De quoy?
C'est par deffault,
Que l'on ne peult merci trouver
Et me convient le temps passer
Martir tout vif, ou autant vault.

Frightful lady!
What do you need?
I'm dying.
Of what?
It's for lack,
For no pity can be found
And I must spend my time
Martyred alive, or as good as.

Missa Ecce ancilla domini: Agnus Dei

The *Agnus Dei* begins with one last transformation of the Mass's head motive. As you follow the upper voices in the opening duo, take a moment to reflect on Ockeghem's melodic writing. His lush, practically sensual lines have unmistakable direction — and yet they also seem to wander, darting maddeningly to a note one would never expect, or eschewing the obvious rhythmic pattern in favor of something more complex. This is Ockeghem's canny effortlessness, his graceful drive — his voluptuous virtuosity.

Agnus dei, qui tollis peccata mundi,
miserere nobis.

Lamb of God, you who take away the sins
of the world, have mercy on us.

Agnus dei, qui tollis peccata mundi,
miserere nobis.

Lamb of God, you who take away the sins
of the world, have mercy on us.

Agnus dei, qui tollis peccata mundi,
dona nobis pacem.

Lamb of God, you who take away the sins
of the world, grant us peace.

A qui vens tu tes coquilles

At first blush, the music gives no indication as to the baseness of this song's subject matter: it is a stunning work, with lines that soar upward to magical heights. And yet upon closer inspection, one can hear traces of the red-faced old fogie described in the text. The sudden introduction of triplets in the phrase "Trousse ton sac et tes bouges" ("Load up your sack and your tackle") sounds decidedly naughty. And the concluding melisma ("quilles"), with its jumpy rhythms, can be read as sarcastic — as seems to be true of the poem, which more or less brands the addressee a naïvely generous Santa and a prostitute's John.

(*Rondeau*)

A	A qui vens tu tes coquilles, Viellart aux paupieres rouges?	Who are you palming off your shells to, Old man with the red eyelids?
B	Trousse ton sac et tes bouges, Et si porte ailleurs tes quilles.	Load up your sack and your tackle And shift your stumps somewhere else.
a	Car pour le deduit des filles Faut bien galans plus harouges.	The girls' delight, you see, Calls for lads with a lot more spunk.
A	A qui…	Who…
a	Tu sces que, quant pour tes pilles T'ont festoié fines gouges,	You know it: after sharp-witted sluts have Welcomed you warmly for your small change,
b	Qu'elles crient, quant tu bouges, Adieu Clais! ou adieu Gilles.	They call out as you move off: "Goodbye, Santa!" or "Goodbye, John!"
AB	A qui…	Who…

Missa Ecce ancilla domini: Sanctus

Here, for the first time, Ockeghem brings in the lower voices in the normal fashion: after an extended introductory duet, the tenor and bass enter simultaneously. Still, the first section of the *Sanctus* is not without its twists and turns, including a string of syncopations toward the end of the opening duo and a fairly dramatic pause before the concluding drive.

Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus dominus deus sabaoth.	Holy, holy, holy Lord God of hosts.
Pleni sunt celi et terra gloria tua.	Heaven and earth are full of your glory.
Osanna in excelsis.	Hosanna in the highest.
Benedictus	Blessed
Qui venit in nomine domini.	is he who comes in the name of the Lord.
Osanna in excelsis.	Hosanna in the highest.

Maintes femmes

With *Maintes femmes* we turn on a dime from water organs to scorned lovers — and yet this song bears a striking connection to *In hydraulis*: its tenor is also based on a rigid scheme, this time conveyed with a long, riddle-like instruction that makes use of Latinized Greek. Given the subject of the poem, in which an arrogant man condescendingly describes women who have lost his favor, this technical apparatus is rather funny. Perhaps we are meant to understand Busnoys's music, scored unusually for four voices, as similarly self-important.

(*Virelai.* The tierce is lacking, hence the form AbbA, rather than AbbaA.)

A	Maintes femmes m'ont dit souvent Que d'anoy se trespasseroient Aussi tost qu'elles perderoient Ma grace, mais ce n'est que vent.	Many women have often told me That they would die of grief The moment they'd lose My favor — but that's just hot air.
b	Donc je ne suis pas esperdu, Mais que plus est, je vous asseure,	I'm not distressed by this; Indeed, what's more, I assure you
b	Que les pluseurs qui l'ont perdu Sont en tres bon point a ceste heure.	That the numerous women who have lost it Are in very good shape right now.
A	Maintes femmes…	Many women…

A vous sans aultre

A vous sans aultre is a textural freak: instead of a typical combination of voices in the arrangement high-medium-low, we find three high voices that often cross. The result is a shimmering musical texture, with imitative phrases that give the impression of tripping over one another. An especially poignant moment occurs at the start of the B section: as the lover observes himself to be "constrained by your face" (A ce me constraint votre face), the voices suddenly ascend, in turn, to the highest part of the range (a'-c''-b'-a').

(*Rondeau*: AB aA ab AB. The acrostic spells out "Jaqueline" — a.k.a., Jacqueline de Hacqueville, for whom Busnoys wrote at least four songs.)

A	A vous sans autre me viens rendre **I**l m'est force qu'ainsi le face;	I give myself up to you And no other; I simply must,
B	**A** ce me constraint vostre face **Q**ui tant est belle, doulce et tendre.	Constrained to do so by your face, Quite beautiful, pleasing, and tender.
a	**V**euillez vo pitié condescendre **E**nvers moi qui de prime face	Uncork your pity, let it flow down towards me: Ever since I first saw you,
A	A vous sans aultre…	I give myself up to you…
a	**L**e vous dire n'ose entreprendre, **J**amais en moi n'eust tant d'audace;	Let you know? I daren't even begin. I could never be so bold;
b	**N**e au moins pretendant estre en grace **E**n tant que honneur se [peut] estendre,	Nevertheless, seeking your favor Everywhere that honor may reach,
AB	A vous sans aultre…	I give myself up to you…

Missa Ecce ancilla domini: Credo

For reasons having perhaps to do with long-range formal thinking, Ockeghem often goes low in the *Credo*. In this Mass all voices acquire a flat signature, and the tenor, which continues to quote the "Ecce ancilla" chant, drops down a fifth. The fallout is significant. For one thing, the modality shifts from G to C, with an opening cadence that arrives surprisingly on C and subsequent arrivals, also on C, that show blatant disregard for the overall pitch center of the Mass. For another, the tenor now occupies a range that effectively replicates that of the bass. This affects the overall sound of the *Credo* by creating two low, rumbling voices that often cross, as during the magical duo at the text "Et in unum dominum… secula," and again (much later) at "Et iterum…finis."

Credo in unum deum,	I believe in one God,
Patrem omnipotentem,	the father almighty,
factorem celi et terre,	maker of heaven and earth,
visibilium omnium et invisibilium.	of all things visible and invisible.
Et in unum dominum Jesum Christum,	I believe in one lord Jesus Christ,
filium dei unigenitum,	the only begotten son of God,
et ex patre natum ante omnia secula.	born of the father before all ages.
Deum de deo, lumen de lumine,	God from God, light from light,
deum verum de deo vero,	true God from true God,
Genitum, non factum,	begotten, not made,
consubstantialem patri:	consubstantial with the father;
Per quem omnia facta sunt.	through him all things were made.
Qui propter nos homines et propter	For us men and for
nostram salutem	our salvation
descendit de celis.	he came down from heaven;
Et incarnatus est de spiritu sancto	And by the holy spirit was incarnate of the
ex Maria virgine, et homo factus est.	virgin Mary, and became man.
Crucifixus etiam pro nobis sub	For our sake he was crucified under
Pontio Pilato;	Pontius Pilate,
passus, et sepultus est,	he suffered death and was buried.

Et resurrexit tertia die,	And he rose again on the third day
secundum scripturas,	in accordance with the scriptures.
Et ascendit in celum,	He ascended into heaven and
sedet ad dexteram patris.	is seated at the right hand of the father.
Et iterum venturus est cum gloria,	He will come again in glory
judicare vivos et mortuos,	to judge the living and the dead
cuius regni non erit finis.	and his kingdom will have no end.
Et in spiritum sanctum,	I believe in the holy spirit, the Lord,
dominum et vivificantem:	the giver of life,
qui ex patre filioque procedit.	who proceeds from the father and the son,
Qui cum patre et filio simul adoratur	who with the father and the son is adored
et conglorificatur:	and glorified,
Qui locutus est per prophetas.	who has spoken through the prophets.
Et unam, sanctam, catholicam	I believe in one, holy, catholic,
et apostolicam ecclesiam.	and apostolic Church.
Confiteor unum baptisma in	I confess one baptism for the
remissionem peccatorum.	forgiveness of sins
Et expecto resurrectionem	and I look forward to the resurrection
mortuorum,	of the dead
Et vitam venturi seculi. Amen.	and the life of the world to come. Amen.

Quant vous me ferez

In Quant vous me ferez ("When you will do for me more good…Then you will be so sure of me"), the poet sets up a contrast between the refrain, with its quid pro quo, and the non-refrain verses, which read like traditional courtly love poetry. Innocent-sounding affirmations like "Mon cueur est votre, non pas mien" ("My heart is yours, not mine at all") are thrown off-kilter by the return of the refrain text, which reminds us that such promises are conditional upon the speaker's oft-repeated demand.

(*Rondeau*: AB aA ab AB)

A	Quant vous me ferez plus de bien	When you do me more good
	Que ne me faictes a ceste heure,	Than you're doing for me right now,
B	Alors serez de moi tant seure	Then you'll be so sure of me
	Qu'on ne scaroit dire combien.	That nobody could say how much.
a	Mon cueur est votre, non pas mien,	My heart is yours, not mine,
	Et le sera, je vous asseure,	And it will be, I assure you,
A	Quant vous me ferez…	When you do me…
a	Congnoistre povez assez bien	You can see very clearly
	Qu'a vous servir tousjours labeure,	That I continually strive to serve you,
b	Et prie a dieu que bref je meure	And I pray God that I die right away
	Ou cas que je vous faille en rien.	If I fail you in any way.
AB	Quant vous me ferez…	When you do me…